SSC CHSL 2021 Tier-I question paper with answers

2 June 2022 · Shift 1

82 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 18 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20220816140307/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2021_16082022.pdf

English Language 23 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. White elephant

(A) Useful and expensive possession
(B) Memorable possession
(C) Costly but useless possession
(D) Motivational possession

Q.2

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. One thing that can be divided

(A) Remainder
(B) Quotient
(C) Dividend
(D) Divisible

Q.3

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Banter

(A) Repartee
(B) Rebuke
(C) Reliance
(D) Commendation

Q.4

Parts of the given sentence have been underlined and given as options. One of them contains an error. Select the option that correctly rectifies the error. It is possible “to prevent oneself” “with respiratory diseases” “by maintaining” “a disciplined lifestyle.”

(A) of prevent oneself
(B) to a disciplined lifestyle
(C) on maintaining
(D) from respiratory diseases

Q.5

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To put someone's back up

(A) To flatter someone
(B) To irritate someone
(C) To help someone
(D) To deceive someone

Q.6

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Movement
(B) Career
(C) Carrier
(D) Freadom

Q.7

Select the most appropriate spelling that can substitute the underlined word in the given sentence. He had to prepare for his “competation”

(A) competetion
(B) compitition
(C) competion
(D) competition

Q.8

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. The door was opened by the children for their father.

(A) The children was opened the door for their father.
(B) The children are opens the door for their father.
(C) The children opened the door for their father.
(D) The children opens the door for their father.

Q.9

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Though he is stout, he runs _____.

(A) faster
(B) fastest
(C) fast
(D) fastly

Q.12

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Austere

(A) Promising
(B) Stern
(C) Brisk
(D) Mitigating

Q.13

Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. The Minister announced that the bridge would constructed within a week.

(A) No error
(B) that the bridge would constructed
(C) The Minister announced
(D) within a week

Q.14

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. Two astronomers – Johannes Kepler from Germany and Galileo from Italy – supported the Copernican theory after nearly a century passed by. B. Copernicus' view was that the sun was stationary and the earth and the planets moved in orbits around the sun. C. Nicholas Copernicus, a Polish priest, proposed a model in 1514. D. There are many popular theories about the solar system. Ancient People believed that the sun moved around the earth and the earth was static.

(A) BCAD
(B) ABCD
(C) DCBA
(D) DACB

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. They "had eaten" an apple every day for breakfast.

(A) eaten
(B) eat
(C) has eaten
(D) eating

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Famous

(A) Quiet
(B) Concert
(C) Obscure
(D) Affluent

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Other countries of comparable size and exposure to Information and Communication Technologies (ICT) have adopted a decentralised organizational structure, liberal policies, and a _____ dispute resolution mechanism, deployed state-of-the-art infrastructure and used the private- public partnership to market Domain Name Registration Services (DNS), resulting in phenomenal growth of their country code domain name.

(A) short
(B) narrow
(C) restricted
(D) comprehensive

Q.18

Select the sentence which has no spelling error.

(A) Aries is the first sign of the zodiac.
(B) Many cities are named after zodaic signs.
(C) Water bearer is the symbol for zodiak Aquarius.
(D) The zodyac signs are split in twelve months.

Q.19

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Unselfish interest in the welfare of others

(A) Celibacy
(B) Misanthropy
(C) Egoism
(D) Altruism

Q.20

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. I am going to ask all employees about the incident that took place in the canteen yesterday.

(A) All the employees are gone to be asked about the incident that took place in the canteen yesterday.
(B) All the employees are going to be asked about the incident that took place in the canteen yesterday.
(C) All the employees are asked by me about the incident that took place in the canteen yesterday.
(D) All the employees will go to be questioned by me about the incident that took place in the canteen yesterday.

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Salander sat for a while (1) _____ the telephone after Armansky hung up. She went to her work corner in the living room (2) _____ looked at the notes she had pinned up on the wall and the papers she had (3)_____ on the desk. What she had managed to collect was mostly press cuttings and articles (4)_____ from the Internet. She took the papers and dropped (5) _____ in a desk drawer.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) to be holding
(B) holds
(C) holding
(D) hold

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Salander sat for a while (1) _____ the telephone after Armansky hung up. She went to her work corner in the living room (2) _____ looked at the notes she had pinned up on the wall and the papers she had (3)_____ on the desk. What she had managed to collect was mostly press cuttings and articles (4)_____ from the Internet. She took the papers and dropped (5) _____ in a desk drawer.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) and
(B) so
(C) but
(D) although

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Salander sat for a while (1) _____ the telephone after Armansky hung up. She went to her work corner in the living room (2) _____ looked at the notes she had pinned up on the wall and the papers she had (3)_____ on the desk. What she had managed to collect was mostly press cuttings and articles (4)_____ from the Internet. She took the papers and dropped (5) _____ in a desk drawer.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) tacked
(B) slacked
(C) mounded
(D) stacked

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Salander sat for a while (1) _____ the telephone after Armansky hung up. She went to her work corner in the living room (2) _____ looked at the notes she had pinned up on the wall and the papers she had (3)_____ on the desk. What she had managed to collect was mostly press cuttings and articles (4)_____ from the Internet. She took the papers and dropped (5) _____ in a desk drawer.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) cropped
(B) uploaded
(C) cut
(D) downloaded

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Salander sat for a while (1) _____ the telephone after Armansky hung up. She went to her work corner in the living room (2) _____ looked at the notes she had pinned up on the wall and the papers she had (3)_____ on the desk. What she had managed to collect was mostly press cuttings and articles (4)_____ from the Internet. She took the papers and dropped (5) _____ in a desk drawer.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) it
(B) them
(C) they
(D) that

General Intelligence 18 questions

Q.2

In a certain code language, 'CONCEPT' is written as ‘3o14c5p20’ and ‘PROBLEM’ is written as ‘16r15b12e13’. How will 'SOLVE' be written in that language?

(A) Po12v5
(B) 19o12v5
(C) 18o12v5
(D) 19o1345

Q.3

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1.Necessary 2.Networks 3.Negotiate 4.Needlework 5.Neigh

(A) 4,1,3,5,2
(B) 1,4,3,5,2
(C) 3,4,1,5,2
(D) 3,1,5,4,2

Q.5

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 7, 7, 9, 27, 31, 155,?

(A) 166
(B) 183
(C) 161
(D) 181

Q.6

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 9 : 135 :: 6 : 54 : :7 : ?

(A) 84
(B) 74
(C) 77
(D) 85

Q.7

Select the option that represents the letters that, when sequentially placed from left to right in the blanks below, will complete the letter series. H _H_ _ S r _ a H _ _ S r H _ _ S a S r

(A) a S a H S a a H
(B) a S a S S a a H
(C) S S a H S a a H
(D) a S a a a a a H

Q.8

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. PEARL : LRAEP :: ULTRA : ARTLU :: VIRAL : ?

(A) LIRAV
(B) AIRLV
(C) LARIV
(D) ALRIV

Q.9

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and fourth term related to third term. 12:208 :: 9:108 ::15:?

(A) 350
(B) 360
(C) 325
(D) 365

Q.11

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 207 : 30 : :108 : 19 : : 63 : ?

(A) 18
(B) 20
(C) 14
(D) 11

Q.12

The second number in the given number pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number pairs, except one. Find that odd number pair.

(A) 25 : 125
(B) 49 : 343
(C) 81 : 730
(D) 36 : 216

Q.13

In a certain code language, 'CURD' is written as '342184' and 'BREAD' is written as '2181024'. How will 'BUTTER' be written in that language?

(A) 442201018
(B) 421201018
(C) 24220201018
(D) 2212020518

Q.14

Select the option that is related to the fourth term in the same way as the first term is related to the second term and the fifth term is related to the sixth term 16 : 36 :: ? : 50 :: 9 : 22

(A) 31
(B) 23
(C) 34
(D) 22

Q.16

Select the option that is related to the third number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the sixth number is related to the fifth number. 21 : 54 :: 24 : ? :: 29 : 78

(A) 56
(B) 63
(C) 30
(D) 49

Q.17

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1. Facsimile 2. Frightful 3. Favourable 4. Fructification 5. Fanatical

(A) 1,4,2,5,3
(B) 1,3,4,2,5
(C) 1,5,3,2,4
(D) 1,3,4,5,2

Q.21

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 50 * 24 * 2 * 5 * 3

(A) +, =, ×, ×
(B) =, +, +, +
(C) −, =, +, ×
(D) =, ×, +, −

Q.22

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (37, 28, 333) (41, 39, 82) (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is NOT allowed)

(A) (18, 13, 90)
(B) (17, 14, 67)
(C) (16, 12, 54)
(D) (19, 15, 44)

Q.23

The second number in the given number pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number pairs, EXCEPT one. Find that odd number pair.

(A) 50 : 150
(B) 30 : 80
(C) 40 : 120
(D) 20 : 60

Q.24

In a certain code language, “QUOTE” is written as “RWRXJ”, and “UNION” is written as “VPLSS”. How will “YOUNG” be written in that language?

(A) ZQXRL
(B) ZQWRL
(C) ZPXRL
(D) ZQXQL

Q.25

Which letter cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? UQMI, VOPE, WMSA, ?, YIYS

(A) XKWV
(B) KXWV
(C) XKVW
(D) XVWK

Quantitative Aptitude 16 questions

Q.1

In a circular race of 2500 m, a man and a woman start from a point towards opposite directions with speeds of 37 km/h and 35 km/h, respectively. After how much time from the start of the race will they meet for the first time?

(A) 2 min 40 sec
(B) 2 min 30 sec
(C) 2 min 5 sec
(D) 2 min 20 sec

Q.2

What will be the area of a triangle whose sides are 13 cm, 5 cm and 12 cm?

(A) 50 cm^2
(B) 40 cm^2
(C) 35 cm^2
(D) 30 cm^2

Q.4

Find the fourth proportional to 7, 13 and 21.

(A) 14
(B) 26
(C) 39
(D) 21

Q.6

$3 \sin A - 4 \sin^3 A = ?$

(A) cot3A
(B) sin3A
(C) cos3A
(D) tan3A

Q.7

Find the ratio in which a grocer should mix two varieties of pulses costing ₹75 and ₹90 per kg, respectively, so as to get a mixture costing ₹80 per kg.

(A) 2 : 3
(B) 3 : 2
(C) 1 : 2
(D) 2 : 1

Q.8

The expenses of a family on wheat, vegetables and oil are in the ratio 12 : 8 : 5. The prices of these items increased by 50%, 25% and 40%, respectively. The total expenses of the family on these items increased by:

(A) 40%
(B) 38%
(C) 44%
(D) 42%

Q.10

A shopkeeper gives a 35% discount on the marked price of a bottle. If the selling price of the bottle is ₹ 1,755, then the marked price of the bottle will be:

(A) ₹2800
(B) ₹2500
(C) ₹2700
(D) ₹3500

Q.11

The average age of a group is increased by 6 years when a person whose age is 24 years was replaced by a person whose age is 66. Find the number of persons in the group.

(A) 8
(B) 9
(C) 6
(D) 7

Q.12

A sells an article to B at 10% profit. B sells it to C at 25% profit. If C pays ₹6,875 for it, then the price at which A bought it is:

(A) ₹4,665
(B) ₹4,850
(C) ₹5,000
(D) ₹5,500

Q.14

What will be the present value of ₹90,774 due 2 years hence, when the interest is compounded at 23% per annum?

(A) ₹65,000
(B) ₹62,950
(C) ₹60,850
(D) ₹60,000

Q.15

Simplify: 178.01– [86.23 – {40.22 + (28 – 24)}]

(A) 125
(B) 120
(C) 130
(D) 136

Q.16

The value of a residential flat constructed at a cost of ₹10,00,000 is depreciating at a rate of 10% per annum. What will be its value 3 years after the construction

(A) ₹2,78,000
(B) ₹7,29,000
(C) ₹7,92,000
(D) ₹6,29,000

Q.18

Sonam is a cab driver, who plies within a city. The number of kilometres that she drives on a Tuesday was 12.5% less than the number of kilometres that she drives on the day before.On the other hand, the number of kilometres that she drives on Wednesday was 20% more than the number of kilometres that she drives on Tuesday. If Sonam drives a total of 336 km on Wednesday, how many kilometres did she drive on Monday?

(A) 315 km
(B) 318 km
(C) 320 km
(D) 324 km

Q.20

The largest six-digit number exactly divisible by 81 is:

(A) 999876
(B) 999945
(C) 999989
(D) 999991

Q.22

A is 3 times as fast as B and is, therefore, able to complete a work in 32 days lesser than B. A and B, working together, can complete the work in _____.

(A) 10 days
(B) 12 days
(C) 16 days
(D) 14 days

Q.25

Simplify the expression $((82\times82) - (18\times18))^{0.5}$

(A) 100
(B) 20
(C) 40
(D) 80

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Who among the following wrote two books on the history and dance structure of Mohiniyattam?

(A) Kalamandalam Radhika
(B) Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma
(C) Kalamandalam Hymavathi
(D) Thankamani

Q.2

In which year will India host the ICC Champions Trophy?

(A) 2022
(B) 2025
(C) 2023
(D) 2029

Q.3

Malka Jaan of Agra Gharana was the court musician at the durbar of which of the following Nawabs of Calcutta?

(A) Shuza-ud-Daula
(B) Wajid Ali Shah
(C) Asaf-ud-Daula
(D) Mohammad Ali Shah

Q.4

Who among the following Indian singers has written ‘Raag Sarita’?

(A) Pandit Kumar Gandharva
(B) Balasaheb Poonchwale
(C) Chintaman Raghunath Vyas
(D) Vishnu Narayan Bhatkhande

Q.5

The first train inaugurated in 1853 was between which two stations?

(A) Delhi and Chandigarh
(B) Mumbai and Thane
(C) Mumbai and Surat
(D) Bangalore and Mysore

Q.6

Ustad Bade Ghulam Ali Khan was renowned a_____.

(A) sarod player
(B) harmonium player
(C) tabla player
(D) classical singer

Q.7
The title of the autobiography of actor Dilip Kumar is _____.

(A) The Substance And The Shadow: An Autobiography
(B) Romancing With Life: An Autobiography
(C) Actually … I Met Them
(D) An Unfinished Story

Q.8
Who won the Saraswati Samman for the year 2020?

(A) Padma Sachdev
(B) Sharankumar Limbale
(C) Amitabha Bagchi
(D) Leeladhar Jagudi

Q.9
Indian men's hockey team won its first Olympic gold medal in which year?

(A) 1928
(B) 1922
(C) 1956
(D) 1920

Q.10
What is the domestic income if national income is ₹10,000 crore and net factor income from abroad is ₹2,000 crore?

(A) ₹5,000 crore
(B) ₹12,000 crore
(C) ₹10,000 crore
(D) ₹8,000 crore

Q.11
The bodies of the animals of phylum Platyhelminthes show _____ grade organisation.

(A) tissue-organ
(B) protoplasmic
(C) cellular
(D) cell-tissue

Q.12
Who was famous for inventing the power battery, one of the first devices to provide a reliable source of electricity, in 1800?

(A) Alessandro Volta
(B) Michael Faraday
(C) Luigi Galvani
(D) Henri Becquerel

Q.13
Whose autobiography is titled ‘Ace against Odds’?

(A) Sania Mirza
(B) Mary Kom
(C) Karnam Malleswari
(D) PT Usha

Q.14
Which group was given the name ‘paraffin’ earlier?

(A) Aldehydes
(B) Alkanes
(C) Alcohols
(D) Acids

Q.15
Who among the following was the third Vice-President of India?

(A) BD Jatti
(B) Zakir Hussain
(C) Gopal Swarup Pathak
(D) V VGiri

Q.16
Uma Sharma was conferred the Padma Bhushan award for enriching which of the following forms of Classical Dances in India?

(A) Kathak
(B) Bharatanatyam
(C) Manipuri
(D) Odissi

Q.17
Mrinalini Sarabhai was awarded the _____ in 1992.

(A) Padma Vibhushan
(B) Padma Shri
(C) Padma Bhushan
(D) Bharat Ratna

Q.18
Vilayat Khan is associated with which musical instrument?

(A) Tabla
(B) Bansuri
(C) Sitar
(D) Santoor

Q.19
Who among the following invented and perfected India's classical dance form Sattras?

(A) Srimanta Sankardev
(B) K Uma Rama Rao
(C) Uday Shankar
(D) Guru Gopinath

Q.20
Which sea is the north-western part of the Indian Ocean that covers a total area of approximately 14,91,000 square miles and forms a part of the major sea route between Europe and India?

(A) Arabian Sea
(B) Caspian Sea
(C) Caribbean Sea
(D) Mediterranean Sea

Q.21
Who among the following Indians was selected as a member of International Law Commission for a 5 year term starting January 1, 2023 in the month of November 2021?

(A) Vinod Rai
(B) Bimal Jalan
(C) Suresh Prabhu
(D) Bimal Patel

Q.22
Find the odd one out with respect to animals' response to abiotic factors.

(A) Suspend
(B) Migrate
(C) Conform
(D) Reproduce

Q.23
Which is the major microtubule-organising centre (MTOC) in eukaryotic cells involved in various cellular processes, including sensory reception, locomotion, and embryogenesis?

(A) Lysosomes
(B) Centrosome
(C) Plastids
(D) Vacuoles

Q.24
The 'Nijaat' (riddance) anti-drug campaign launched by a district police of which state has been acknowledged and appreciated by many Bollywood actors in 2021?

(A) West Bengal
(B) Chhattisgarh
(C) Punjab
(D) Maharashtra

Q.25

Who is the only Indian female sportsperson to win two consecutive Olympic medals?

(A) Dutee Chand

(B) PV Sindhu

(C) Mary Kom

(D) Mirabai Chanu

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(C)**
Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(B)**
Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(B)**	

General Intelligence

Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**
Q.9 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**
Q.17 **(C)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(C)**

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**
Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**
Q.18 **(C)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.25 **(D)**		

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (C) Costly but useless possession

A 'white elephant' is a possession that costs a great deal to keep but is of little use.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Divisible

SSC's key gives 'divisible', able to be divided, the usual one-word substitute for 'that which can be divided' (as 'edible' is for 'that which can be eaten'). A 'dividend' is the number being divided in a particular sum, the quotient the result and the remainder what is left over.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Repartee

'Banter' is playful, teasing talk: 'repartee', a quick and witty exchange.

Q.4 · Answer (D) from respiratory diseases

'Prevent' takes 'from', not 'with': 'to prevent oneself from respiratory diseases'.

Q.5 · Answer (B) To irritate someone

To 'put someone's back up' is to annoy or irritate them.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Freadom

'Freadom' is misspelt: the correct spelling is 'freedom'.

Q.7 · Answer (D) competition

The correct spelling is 'competition'.

Q.8 · Answer (C) The children opened the door for their father.

The simple past passive 'was opened by the children' becomes the simple past active 'The children opened the door', with 'for their father' kept.

Q.9 · Answer (C) fast

'Fast' is itself the adverb ('fastly' is not a word), and with nothing compared the plain form fits, not 'faster' or 'fastest'.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Stern

'Austere' means severe and strict in manner: 'stern'.

Q.13 · Answer (B) that the bridge would constructed

The passive needs 'be': 'the bridge would be constructed within a week'.

Q.14 · Answer (C) DCBA

D introduces the theories and the old belief, C brings in Copernicus's model of 1514, B gives his view, and A tells how Kepler and Galileo supported it a century later: DCBA.

Q.15 · Answer (B) eat

A daily habit takes the simple present: 'They eat an apple every day for breakfast.'

Q.16 · Answer (C) Obscure

'Famous' means widely known; its opposite is 'obscure', little known.

Q.17 · Answer (D) comprehensive

The sentence lists strengths that brought growth (decentralisation, liberal policies), so the mechanism is a 'comprehensive' one; 'short', 'narrow' and 'restricted' would be weaknesses.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Aries is the first sign of the zodiac.

Only the first sentence spells 'zodiac' correctly; the others have 'zodaic', 'zodiak' and 'zodyac'.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Altruism

Altruism is unselfish concern for the welfare of others; misanthropy is dislike of people, egoism self-interest and celibacy abstaining from marriage.

Q.20 · Answer (B) All the employees are going to be asked about the incident that took place in the canteen yesterday.

'Am going to ask' becomes 'are going to be asked', with 'all employees' as the subject; the agent 'by me' can be dropped.

Q.21 · Answer (C) holding

She sat for a while 'holding' the telephone: the participle says how she sat.

Q.22 · Answer (A) and

Two actions in sequence: she went to her work corner 'and' looked at the notes.

Q.23 · Answer (D) stacked

Papers kept in a pile on a desk are 'stacked'; 'tacked' means pinned in place, 'slacked' means loosened, and 'mounded', heaped into a mound, is not the usual word for papers.

Q.24 · Answer (D) downloaded

Articles taken from the Internet are 'downloaded'.

Q.25 · Answer (B) them

The pronoun stands for 'the papers', a plural object: 'dropped them'.

General Intelligence

Q.2 · Answer (B) 19o12v5

Letters in odd places are written as their positions in the alphabet and those in even places as small letters: C = 3, o, N = 14, c, E = 5, p, T = 20. So SOLVE → 19, o, 12, v, 5: 19o12v5.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 1,4,3,5,2

In dictionary order: Necessary (1), Needlework (4), Negotiate (3), Neigh (5), Networks (2). 'Nec' comes before 'Nee', 'Neg', 'Nei' and 'Net'.

Q.5 · Answer (C) 161

The steps alternate: ×1, +2, ×3, +4, ×5, so the next is +6: 155 + 6 = 161.

Q.6 · Answer (C) 77

The second number is the first times (twice the first minus 3): 9 × 15 = 135 and 6 × 9 = 54. Likewise 7 × 11 = 77.

Q.7 · Answer (A) a S a H S a a H

With a, S, a, H, S, a, a, H in the blanks the block HaHSaSr repeats: HaHSaSr HaHSaSr HaHSaSr.

Q.8 · Answer (C) LARIV

Each word is written in reverse: PEARL → LRAEP and ULTRA → ARTLU. So VIRAL → LARIV.

Q.9 · Answer (A) 350

The second number is the square of the first plus the cube of one third of it: $12^2 + 4^3 = 144 + 64 = 208$ and $9^2 + 3^3 = 81 + 27 = 108$. Likewise $15^2 + 5^3 = 225 + 125 = 350$.

Q.11 · Answer (C) 14

The second number is the first divided by 9, plus 7: 207 ÷ 9 + 7 = 30 and 108 ÷ 9 + 7 = 19. Likewise 63 ÷ 9 + 7 = 14.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 81 : 730

Each pair is a square and the cube of the same root: 25 and 125 (5), 49 and 343 (7), 36 and 216 (6). $81 = 9^2$, but $9^3 = 729$, not 730.

Q.13 · Answer (C) 24220201018

Consonants are written as their positions in the alphabet and vowels as twice theirs: C = 3, U = 42, R = 18, D = 4; B = 2, R = 18, E = 10, A = 2, D = 4. So BUTTER → 2, 42, 20, 20, 10, 18: 24220201018.

Q.14 · Answer (B) 23
The second term is twice the first plus 4: 16 × 2 + 4 = 36 and 9 × 2 + 4 = 22. So ? × 2 + 4 = 50 gives 23.

Q.16 · Answer (B) 63
The second number is three times the first minus 9: 21 × 3 − 9 = 54 and 29 × 3 − 9 = 78. Likewise 24 × 3 − 9 = 63.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 1,5,3,2,4
In dictionary order: Facsimile (1), Fanatical (5), Favourable (3), Frightful (2), Fructification (4). 'Fac', 'Fan' and 'Fav' come in that order, and 'Fri' before 'Fru'.

Q.21 · Answer (D) =, ×, +, −
50 = 24 × 2 + 5 − 3 = 48 + 5 − 3 = 50.

Q.22 · Answer (A) (18, 13, 90)
The third number is the first times the difference of the first two: 37 × (37 − 28) = 37 × 9 = 333 and 41 × (41 − 39) = 82. Likewise 18 × (18 − 13) = 18 × 5 = 90.

Q.23 · Answer (B) 30 : 80
In the other pairs the second number is three times the first: 50 × 3 = 150, 40 × 3 = 120 and 20 × 3 = 60. 30 × 3 = 90, not 80.

Q.24 · Answer (A) ZQXRL
The letters move +1, +2, +3, +4, +5: QUOTE → RWRXJ and UNION → VPLSS. So YOUNG → ZQXRL.

Q.25 · Answer (C) XKVW
First letters move +1 (U, V, W, X, Y), second letters −2 (Q, O, M, K, I), third letters +3 (M, P, S, V, Y) and fourth letters −4 (I, E, A, W, S): XKVW.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 · Answer (C) 2 min 5 sec
Running in opposite directions they close the gap at 37 + 35 = 72 km/h = 20 m/s, so they first meet after 2500/20 = 125 seconds: 2 min 5 sec.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 30 cm²
$5^2 + 12^2 = 13^2$, so the triangle is right-angled with legs 5 cm and 12 cm: area = ½ × 5 × 12 = 30 cm².

Q.4 · Answer (C) 39
7 : 13 = 21 : x, so x = 13 × 21/7 = 39.

Q.6 · Answer (B) sin3A
The triple-angle formula: sin 3A = 3 sin A − 4 $\sin^3$A.

Q.7 · Answer (D) 2 : 1
By alligation: (90 − 80) : (80 − 75) = 10 : 5 = 2 : 1.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 40%
Taking the expenses as 12, 8 and 5 (total 25), after the rises they are 18, 10 and 7, a total of 35. The rise is 10/25 = 40%.

Q.10 · Answer (C) ₹2700
After a 35% discount 65% of the marked price is paid: 1,755/0.65 = ₹2,700.

Q.11 · Answer (D) 7
The total rises by 66 − 24 = 42 years, which is 6 years for each person: 42/6 = 7 persons.

Q.12 · Answer (C) ₹5,000
₹6,875 = A's cost × 1.10 × 1.25 = 1.375 × A's cost, so A bought it for 6,875/1.375 = ₹5,000.

Q.14 · Answer (D) ₹60,000
Present value = 90,774/1.23^2 = 90,774/1.5129 = ₹60,000.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 136
Innermost first: 28 – 24 = 4, 40.22 + 4 = 44.22, 86.23 – 44.22 = 42.01, and 178.01 – 42.01 = 136.

Q.16 · Answer (B) ₹7,29,000
Three years of 10% depreciation: 10,00,000 × 0.9^3 = 10,00,000 × 0.729 = ₹7,29,000.

Q.18 · Answer (C) 320 km
Tuesday = 0.875 × Monday and Wednesday = 1.2 × Tuesday = 1.05 × Monday. Monday = 336/1.05 = 320 km.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 999945
999999 = 81 × 12345 + 54, so the largest six-digit multiple of 81 is 999999 – 54 = 999945.

Q.22 · Answer (B) 12 days
If A takes t days, B takes 3t, and 3t – t = 32 gives t = 16: A 16 days, B 48. Together they do 1/16 + 1/48 = 4/48 = 1/12 of the work a day: 12 days.

Q.25 · Answer (D) 80
$82^2 – 18^2 = (82 + 18)(82 – 18) = 100 × 64 = 6400$, and the power 0.5 is the square root: $\sqrt{6400} = 80$.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma
Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma, who did much to revive and systematise Mohiniyattam, wrote two books on it in Malayalam, among them 'Mohiniyattam: Charitravum Attaprakaravum' (its history and dance structure).

Q.2 · Answer (D) 2029
Under the ICC's hosting plan for 2024-2031, announced in November 2021, India hosts the 2029 Champions Trophy; Pakistan was given the 2025 edition.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Wajid Ali Shah
SSC's key gives Wajid Ali Shah, the last Nawab of Awadh, who after he was deposed in 1856 lived in exile at Matiaburj in Calcutta and kept a court of musicians there; Malka Jaan of Agra is said to have joined it. The other three were earlier Nawabs of Awadh, at Faizabad or Lucknow.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Chintaman Raghunath Vyas
Pandit C. R. (Chintaman Raghunath) Vyas, the Hindustani vocalist, published 'Raag Sarita', a collection of his own bandishes with their notation.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Mumbai and Thane
India's first passenger train ran from Bombay (Bori Bunder) to Thane on 16 April 1853.

Q.6 · Answer (D) classical singer
Ustad Bade Ghulam Ali Khan of the Patiala gharana was one of the great Hindustani classical vocalists, famed for his khayal and thumri.

Q.7 · Answer (A) The Substance And The Shadow: An Autobiography
Dilip Kumar's autobiography, 'The Substance and the Shadow', was published in 2014. 'Romancing with Life' is Dev Anand's.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Sharankumar Limbale
Sharankumar Limbale received the Saraswati Samman for 2020 for his Marathi novel 'Sanatan'.

Q.9 · Answer (A) 1928
India won its first Olympic hockey gold at Amsterdam in 1928.

Q.10 · Answer (D) ₹8,000 crore
Domestic income = national income – net factor income from abroad = ₹10,000 crore – ₹2,000 crore = ₹8,000 crore.

Q.11 · Answer (A) tissue-organ
Flatworms show the tissue-organ grade: their tissues are built into organs. Protozoans show the protoplasmic grade, sponges the cellular grade and cnidarians the cell-tissue grade.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Alessandro Volta
Alessandro Volta built the voltaic pile in 1800, the first battery to give a steady electric current.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Sania Mirza
'Ace Against Odds', published in 2016, is the autobiography of tennis player Sania Mirza.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Alkanes
Alkanes were once called paraffins, from the Latin 'parum affinis', little affinity, because they react so little.

Q.15 · Answer (D) V VGiri
The Vice-Presidents in order: S. Radhakrishnan, Zakir Husain, V. V. Giri (1967-69), G. S. Pathak and B. D. Jatti.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Kathak
Uma Sharma, the Kathak dancer, received the Padma Bhushan in 2001.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Padma Bhushan
Mrinalini Sarabhai, the classical dancer and founder of the Darpana Academy, received the Padma Bhushan in 1992, after the Padma Shri in 1965.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Sitar
Ustad Vilayat Khan was one of the great sitar players of the twentieth century.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Srimanta Sankardev
Sattriya was created by the Vaishnava saint Srimanta Sankardev in Assam in the 15th-16th century and kept alive in the sattras, the Vaishnava monasteries.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Arabian Sea
The Arabian Sea, the north-western part of the Indian Ocean, covers about 38,62,000 km² (14,91,000 square miles) and is part of the main sea route between Europe and India.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Bimal Patel
In November 2021 Bimal Patel was elected to the UN's International Law Commission for the five-year term beginning on 1 January 2023.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Reproduce
Animals respond to abiotic conditions by regulating, conforming, migrating or suspending activity (hibernation, aestivation, diapause). Reproducing is not one of these responses.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Centrosome
The centrosome, with its pair of centrioles, is the main microtubule-organising centre of animal cells; centrioles also give rise to the basal bodies of cilia and flagella.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Chhattisgarh
SSC's key gives Chhattisgarh, whose police ran 'Nijaat', a campaign against drugs and illicit liquor started by Superintendent of Police Santosh Singh in Koriya and Rajnandgaon districts.

Q.25 · Answer (B) PV Sindhu
P. V. Sindhu won badminton silver at Rio 2016 and bronze at Tokyo 2020, the first Indian woman to win medals at two Olympics in a row.

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